ERIC ZHENG

Executive Producer | Global Creative Operations

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Executive Profile

AI-Creative Bridge: Award-winning Executive Producer with 15+ years at the intersection of cinematic storytelling and emerging technology. Produced Sundance and Berlinale-selected features while pioneering AI-powered production workflows.

Technical Production Expertise: Hands-on experience with generative AI tools (Openclaw, Gemini, Midjourney, Runway, Higgsfield, Veo) and ML-integrated pipelines. Proven ability to translate cutting-edge AI capabilities into professional film, TV, and VFX workflows.

Global Operations: Managed $2.5M+ budgets across international co-productions (China, France, Denmark, Qatar), navigating complex legal, censorship, and technical delivery requirements for Tier-1 theatrical and streaming platforms.

Core Competencies

AI & GENERATIVE MEDIA TOOLS	TECHNICAL-CREATIVE TRANSLATION	RESEARCH ENVIRONMENT PRODUCTION
GLOBAL CO-PRODUCTION & FINANCING	AWARD-WINNING CONTENT DEVELOPMENT	CROSS-FUNCTIONAL TEAM LEADERSHIP
EMERGING TECHNOLOGY INTEGRATION	INTERNATIONAL LEGAL & CENSORSHIP	EXECUTIVE PRODUCTION LEADERSHIP

Professional Experience

Founder & Executive Producer

Jul 2017 — Dec 2025

First Light Films | Shanghai / Global

- **Managed Censorship & Gov Relations (China):** Maneuvered through China's stringent censorship system, successfully orchestrating a cross-provincial project transfer (from Sichuan to Zhejiang Film Bureau) to secure the "Dragon Mark" (Public Screening License) and a 1M RMB local government cultural grant.
- **Led Global Co-Production Financing:** Architected the $2.5M financing structure for the feature film _Brief History of A Family_, successfully pitching and securing top-tier international funds including the French CNC (Aides aux Cinémas du Monde), Ile-de-France regional fund (€115K), Doha Film Institute (DFI) Post-Production Grant, and TorinoFilmLab (TFL) Co-Production Award (€50K).
- **Technical Mastering & Regulatory Affairs:** Directed a three-country production pipeline. Performed rigorous Technical QC on 4.5K masters, personally auditing pixel errors and blanking mistakes in ProRes 4444 XYZ / TIFF sequences to meet Tier-1 theatrical specs. Successfully secured a $150k USD Provincial Arts Fund.

> *Key Achievement: Produced Feature Film - "Brief History of A Family" (IMDB)*
>
> First Chinese debut since 2006 to sweep both **Sundance (World Competition)** and **Berlinale (Panorama)**. Secured theatrical distribution in 60+ territories with **92% Rotten Tomatoes** and Metascore 80.

Executive Producer (Strategic Project Lead)

Jul 2023 — Dec 2024

Final Frontier (Hybrid Creative Agency) | Shanghai / Global

- **Finance & ERP:** Movie Magic Budgeting, Advanced Excel/Numbers.
- **Speheaded S-Tier Commercial & CG Animation Pipelines:** Led the end-to-end production of multi-million RMB/USD campaigns for top-tier global brands and tech/gaming giants (Tencent, Riot Games, miHoYo, Nike, L'Oreal).
- **DTC Revenue Transformation:** Generated $6M+ USD in portfolio revenue within 18 months by pivoting the studio from a traditional vendor model to a Direct-to-Client (DTC) Hybrid Agency model. Led upstream creative pitching and downstream execution for multi-million dollar SOWs.

Lead Producer

Apr 2022 — Jul 2023

Final Frontier | Shanghai

- **Operational Throughput & Efficiency:** Managed concurrent delivery of 10+ premium integrated campaigns annually for Nike, BMW, vivo, NetEase, and POP MART. Optimized SOPs using Jira/Asana, reducing production cycle time by 15% while maintaining "bar-raising" quality standards.

Project Lead (Experiential Production)

Jul 2017 — Dec 2018

IK DESIGN Experiential & Spatial Design | Shanghai

- **Physical Build & Execution Ownership:** Managed end-to-end production for physical activations ($150k - $2M budgets). Controlled complex fabrication pipelines and material sourcing for luxury brand retail and event spaces.

Head of Production Operations

Oct 2015 — Jul 2017

D'ELE Management & Production | Shanghai

- **0-to-1 Business Scaling:** Launched and scaled the agency's internal content division to $1.5M+ revenue in year one. Established foundational financial workflows, vendor compliance protocols, and client billing visibility.
- **Mentored Cross-Functional Teams:** Built and managed a robust internal team of producers and account managers (Catherine Fong, Keira, Phoenix, Lisa Wang, etc.), serving as the ultimate escalation point for creative disputes, timeline crises, and client relationship management. **Production Coordinator / Junior Producer** _KerSound Studios / D'ELE / Independent | 2015 — 2017_

Studio Operations Manager

Jul 2012 — Jul 2015

Ker Sound Studios | Shanghai

- **Coordinated Award-Winning Feature Film:** Served as Production Coordinator for _End of Summer_ (西小河的夏天), managing on-set logistics, crew scheduling, and cross-departmental operations, contributing to its win of the 2017 Busan International Film Festival Audience Choice Award.
- **AAA Asset Delivery:** Supervised 200+ hours of localized assets for AAA gaming titles (including Monster Hunter Online). Acted as the strategic liaison between European leadership and local clients to ensure world-class technical standards.
- **Executed International TVC Campaigns:** Facilitated cross-border commercial shoots, coordinating international directors, DOPs, and styling teams for clients like Coach and Huawei. Handled casting, equipment rentals, and on-set bilingual coordination.

Education & Accolades

Quantic School of Business and Technology

Executive MBA (EMBA) | 2024

Shanghai University

B.A. Film & TV Production | 2008

Selected Accolades

Sundance (Grand Jury nominee), Noir in Festival (Best Film Winner), Camerimage (Best Debut nominee), Zurich Film Festival (Special Mention), Berlinale (Panorama).

Skills & Affiliations

Core Expertise

Global Financing & Co-Production, Chain of Title & Legal Delivery, Technical Post & 4.5K Mastering, AI Tool Integration, Cross-Functional Leadership, Integrated Campaign Delivery, Vendor & Talent Procurement, SOW & Margin Optimization

Tools & Software

Movie Magic Budgeting & Scheduling, Jira (Power User), Asana, Monday.com, frame.io, Adobe Creative Suite, Openclaw, Google Gemini, Midjourney, Runway, Higgsfield, Veo

Affiliations

Member of Gold House